MY FIRST RESEARCH PAPER · ARXIV 2610.16757

Is the platform part of the measurement?

A protocol and simulation study for cross-platform equivalence of machine-labelled policy sentiment

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Swipe →

THE PROBLEM

We pool sentiment across platforms and read the gap as opinion.

X
short, fast, adversarial

Reddit
threaded, long-form

YouTube
reactions under video

Quora
explanatory answers

That only works if a classifier measures **the same construct, on the same scale, on every platform**. Some studies validate platform by platform; to our knowledge none has modelled the platform as a facet of the measurement itself.

THE IDEA

Treat each platform like a survey mode.

Survey researchers test whether a phone and an online questionnaire measure alike before comparing them. We bring that toolkit to machine-labelled text.

Generalizability theory
how much variance is the platform?

Measurement invariance & DIF
does the instrument behave alike?

Score linking
put platforms on one scale

Two-classifier check
a platform effect must survive both

THE PROTOCOL

Six steps before you average.

1. **Same-event divergence**
   do platforms differ on the same event?

2. **Reliability per platform**
   a generalizability study against human labels

3. **Invariance and DIF**
   with the platform as the group

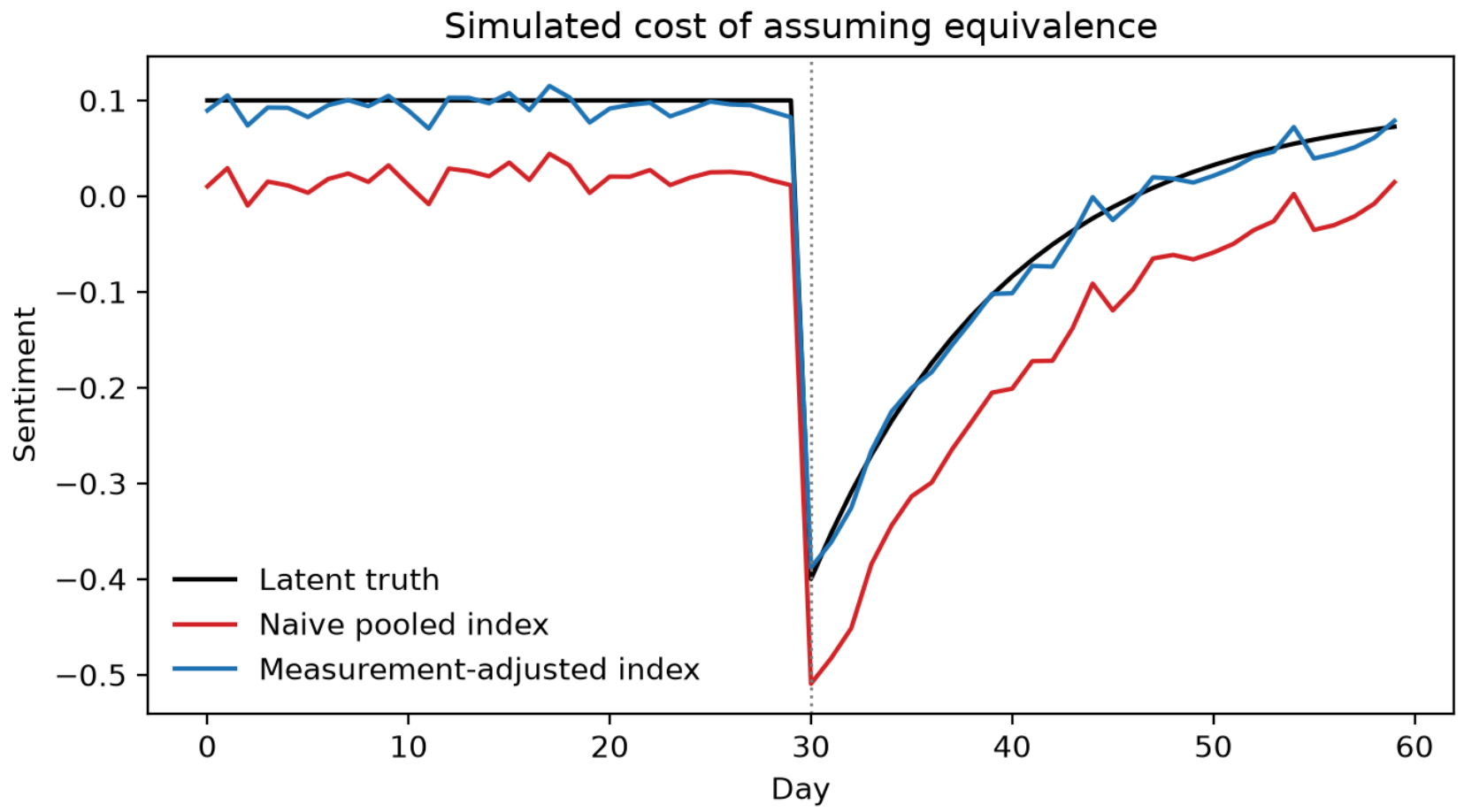
4. **Timing and composition**
   adjust within anchor windows

5. **Score linking**
   through anchor events fixed in advance

6. **Cost of assuming equivalence**
   quantified in simulation

WHAT IT COSTS

Pooling at face value can point the wrong way.



13.8 / 60
days with the wrong sign, naive pooled index

0.8 / 60
days, index adjusted for each platform's measurement

500 replications with known ground truth, one generating configuration.

READ IT · RUN IT · TELL ME WHAT YOU THINK

It began with a flaw in my own dissertation: a validation that turned out to be circular.

📄 arxiv.org/abs/2610.16757
💻 github.com/asadfix/platform-measurement

Feedback welcome, especially on measurement, LLM annotation and cross-platform data.

Looking for a PhD in computational social science for 2027.